

Luster LightTech Co. (688400.SS): 2Q26 in line but with slower revenue recognition pace; maintain Neutral

Post the August 27 market close, Luster reported 2Q26 results with the bottom-line in line but revenue below our expectation. The company's 2Q26 revenue/GP/EBIT/NP were Rmb854mn/Rmb337mn/Rmb61mn/Rmb457mn (+13%/+25%/+84%/+463% yoy), -16%/-15%/+40%/-1% vs. GSe. Implied 2Q26 GPM/OPM/NPM (incl. investment income) were 39%/7%/53% (+4pp/+3pp/+43pp yoy), flat/+3pp/+8pp vs. GSe. The revenue miss mainly reflected a slower overall revenue recognition pace in 1H26, as 1H26 revenue was +6% yoy vs. orders of Rmb2,176mn (incl. VAT), up 20%+ yoy. Looking ahead, management further revised up its FY26 new orders growth target to ~30% yoy (vs. +20% yoy previously). Meanwhile, the GPM expansion (1H26 blended GPM at 40.7%, +5.0pp yoy) and the fair value gain on Luster's equity stake in Zhipu (Rmb589mn investment gain booked in 1H26) cushioned the top-line shortfall, leaving net income performance largely inline.

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Key takeaways:

Downstream divergence continued in 1H26, with consumer electronics/printing/lithium battery/new-generation FPD/Yuanke Vision/semiconductor/AI infrastructure contributing 44%/16%/9%/6%/5%/5%/3% of 1H26 machine vision revenue (Rmb1,137mn, +4% yoy). Consumer electronics was flat in 1H26 but management guided to +20%-30% segment growth for 2027E, as Apple's 2027 pipeline involves major form-factor changes and more complex designs. New-generation FPD benefited from accelerating downstream OLED panel capex, with 1H26 orders +35% yoy and the AOI product co-developed with BOE scaling from Rmb1mn-level orders in 2025 to c.Rmb100mn expected in FY26. Lithium battery grew +120% yoy (orders +170%+) on new-demand breakthroughs in cell appearance/electrode inspection at CATL/EVE.

Luster's product coverage in embodied AI continues to expand from optical motion-capture data collection devices to a multi-modal suite covering ego-centric data, UMI (Universal Manipulation Interface) data collection, and tactile data-collection devices (per-set ASP up from Rmb0.2-0.3mn to c.Rmb1mn). Yuanke Vision's FZMotion revenue grew 80%+ yoy in 1H26, with data-collection revenue up c.2X yoy. Luster's humanoid mass-production EOL (end-of-line) inspection solution also stepped up in performance, with per-unit 160-item testing time cut from 4 hours to 15 minutes, testing headcount cut from 8 to 2, and daily off-line volume increasing from 20 to 100+ units. The company's next

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step target is entering industrial scenarios, enabling humanoids to collect and learn from data while working on site, leveraging its factory know-how and customer base (CATL, Foxconn, etc.).

AI infrastructure delivered a 0-to-1 breakthrough, with optical module AOI, AI server assembly/liquid-cooling inspection, ESS inspection, and AR/AI glasses inspection, together contributing close to Rmb30mn of AI infra revenue in 1H26. In optical module AOI, 1H26 saw small-batch orders from Luxshare's Google program with 2027E expected revenue contribution of c.Rmb100mn, while projects with Innolight were still in the sampling stage. In AI servers, revenue with Foxconn scaled from the Rmb1mn-level in 2025 to Rmb10mn-level in 2026 following Foxconn's capacity build-out across Taiwan/Mexico/the US. Per management, 2027E focus in AI servers will shift to higher-precision upstream components (liquid-cooling plates, PCBs, connectors), targeting Rmb100mn+ combined.

Margin-wise, management attributed the GPM improvement to a product mix upgrade, the dropping of low-margin product categories (cutting SKUs from 130+ to 80) and a rising share of high-margin AI products. Luster's core machine vision business GPM has reached the c.45% level vs. 25%-30% for the optical communication agency business. For FY26, management expects recurring net profit growth to continue outpacing revenue growth.

All in, we raise 2026E-30E net income by 3%-9% on improving product mix and margins. Our 2026E-30E EPS changes by up to 5%, additionally reflecting the larger share count (c.4%) post the placement tied to the JAI acquisition. Accordingly, our 12-month target price is unchanged at Rmb40.1, as the higher net income forecasts are offset by the share dilution. Maintain Neutral.

Exhibit 1: Luster's 2Q26 financial summary

Luster (688400.SS)	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	yoy	qoq	Prior 2Q26 GSe	Diff
Revenue (Rmb mn)	754	759	784	597	854	13%	43%	1,017	-16%
Gross profit (Rmb mn)	269	234	290	253	337	25%	33%	397	-15%
EBIT (Rmb mn)	33	(9)	(38)	27	61	84%	130%	44	40%
Net profit (Rmb mn)	81	37	29	200	457	463%	129%	462	-1%
EPS (Rmb)	0.18	0.08	0.06	0.42	0.95	442%	129%	0.96	-1%
Gross margin (%)	36%	31%	37%	42%	39%	4pp	-3pp	39%	0pp
EBIT margin (%)	4%	-1%	-5%	4%	7%	3pp	3pp	4%	3pp
Net margin (%)	11%	5%	4%	33%	53%	43pp	20pp	45%	8pp

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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Investment Thesis and PTRM

Investment Thesis - Luster LightTech Co.

Within the fast-growing machine vision sub-sector, we expect Luster's market share in traditional machine vision systems to grow mildly on the back of its solution capabilities to service big customers and selective in-house software, cameras and lenses. Beyond traditional machine vision, Luster has been expanding into higher-growth new businesses, including ESS/new energy, AI servers and optical modules, which should support a more favorable product mix and margin profile over time. Starting from 2025, Luster's FZMotion motion capture system also began to increase its exposure to humanoid robot data collection, creating a second growth driver alongside its core machine vision business. While we are constructive on Luster's long-term growth potential from its humanoid MoCap (motion capture) business and higher-margin new businesses, we maintain our Neutral rating as valuation already appears to reflect part of this business mix improvement and humanoid-related optionality.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Luster LightTech Co.

Price target: Our 12-month target price of Rmb40.1 comprises: (1) Rmb32.3 per share for the main business valuation, based on 30x 2030E P/E discounted back to 2027E with an 11.5% CoE, and (2) Rmb7.8 per share for Luster's 0.42% equity stake in Zhipu (2513.HK), based on the GS China Internet team's DCF valuation discounted to 2027E.

Upside/downside risks: (1) Faster/slower-than-expected penetration and recovery in the new energy sector; (2) Faster/slower-than-expected development of vision software; (3) Better/worse-than-expected motion capture business development; (4) Easing/Intensifying pricing competition in the machine vision industry.

688400.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb40.10	Price: Rmb48.10	Downside: 16.6%
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Neutral		GS Forecast			
Market cap: Rmb22.3bn / \$3.3bn Enterprise value: Rmb21.2bn / \$3.2bn 3m ADTV: Rmb978.6mn / \$144.5mn China China Industrial Tech & Machinery M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	2,911.7	3,566.0	4,172.5	4,730.0
	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	84.4	286.4	373.7	463.1
	EPS (Rmb) New	0.35	1.99	0.90	1.08
	EPS (Rmb) Old	0.35	1.89	0.90	1.08
	P/E (X)	94.5	24.2	53.2	44.7
	P/B (X)	3.6	4.7	4.4	4.1
	Dividend yield (%)	0.3	1.2	0.6	0.7
	CROCI (%)	7.7	31.5	17.6	18.5
		3/26	6/26	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.42	0.95	0.27	0.35

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 28 Aug 2026 close.

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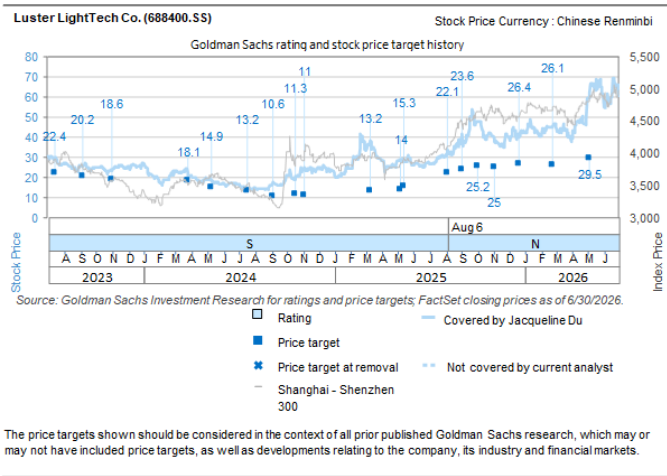
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)
Luster LightTech Co. (688400.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
22-Jul-26	40.10	44.64
05-May-26	29.50	59.32
24-Feb-26	26.10	45.73
22-Dec-25	26.40	40.64
03-Nov-25	25.00	39.36
02-Oct-25	25.20	47.87
02-Sep-25	23.60	40.61
06-Aug-25	22.10	33.87
13-May-25	15.30	28.68
07-May-25	14.00	28.64
12-Mar-25	13.20	37.50
04-Nov-24	11.00	23.60
18-Oct-24	11.30	20.25
05-Sep-24	10.60	17.67
18-Jul-24	13.20	14.11
09-May-24	14.90	18.68
28-Mar-24	18.10	20.76
01-Nov-23	18.60	23.62
06-Sep-23	20.20	25.98

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